LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 53 · November 10, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 53 opens the final perek, מעשר בהמה: tithing every tenth animal, in Eretz Yisrael and chutz la'aretz, with or without a Beis Hamikdash — and why Chazal suspended it anyway, משום תקלה. Along the way: R' Akiva, Elazar ben Azariah's 12,000 animals, אין מקדישין בזמן הזה, and kodshim kalim as ממון בעלים.

אמאי קדוש · THE CHUTZ-LA'ARETZ'DIKEH ANIMAL



1. The Gemara asks what to do with a maaser behemah animal from chutz la'aretz — it can't be brought as a korban, so why is it kadosh at all? That raises a machlokes acharonim: what even counts as a chutz-la'aretz animal?

“The Minchat Chinuch says it depends where the animal was when it became eight days old. The Chazon Ish says it depends where you did the maaser procedure. Same animal, three passports.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 53a · אמאי קדוש — the chutz-la'aretz'dikeh animal · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 11:13

גזירה משום יתום · ELAZAR BEN AZARIAH'S 12,000 ANIMALS



2. Tosafot asks: the Gemara says that after the churban nobody did maaser behemah — yet Shabbos proves Elazar ben Azariah's wealth by saying he gave twelve thousand animals a year for maaser. But he was bar mitzvah only after the churban!

“One pshat: he didn't give them for maaser at all. He gave them for tax — twelve thousand animals a year to the taxman is its own proof of wealth.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 53a · גזירה משום יתום — Elazar ben Azariah's 12,000 animals · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 15:25

משום תקלה · THE SPILLED-MILK BREAD



3. You're not allowed to bake milchig bread — bread is eaten with everything, and you'll end up eating dairy bread with a meat meal. But what if you didn't bake it — milk just spilled onto your bread?

“You don't have to throw the bread out — but you can't put it away for later either. Since Chazal are concerned for takalah, you have to eat it up right away.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 53a · משום תקלה — the spilled-milk bread · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 18:45

LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 53 · November 10, 2026

אין מקדישין בזמן הזה · RAV ELYASHIV'S BURNED BILLS



4. A woman left a tzava'ah makdish a very large sum of money — but there's no hekdesh b'zman hazeh, and the money is stuck: her children can't do anything with it. The question was posed to Rav Elyashiv — and, as Elefant notes, it's hard to talk to dead people.

“Rav Elyashiv: take the dollar bills to the bank, burn them, and the bank will give you new bills — she was only makdish the first batch, not the replacement batch.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 53a · אין מקדישין בזמן הזה — Rav Elyashiv's burned bills · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 23:11

יוליך לים המלח · FOUND MONEY IN THE DEAD SEA



5. If you were makdish money b'zman hazeh, the baraita says: take it to the Dead Sea. The mefarshim explain — in any other sea you'd have to grind the coins up first so they sink; the Dead Sea takes them as-is.

“So Elefant asks: what's the halacha if somebody finds money in the Dead Sea? Does he have to worry it's from all the yam hamelach money of the whole Shas?”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 53a · יוליך לים המלח — found money in the Dead Sea · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 26:22

מהרה יבנה בית המקדש · THE TAKANAH MASHIACH WILL HAVE TO ANSWER FOR



6. Chazal stopped maaser behemah because 'meheirah yibaneh Beis Hamikdash' — the Temple will be rebuilt any moment and we'll need unblemished animals. But the mefarshim ask: Mashiach doesn't come on Shabbos, or Yom Tov, or erev Shabbos — so why make takanos for something so unlikely?

“One answer: the Beis Hamikdash above is already built and could come down any instant. The other: it's an excellent question — and it's going to be one of the questions that Mashiach himself will answer.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 53b · מהרה יבנה בית המקדש — the question Mashiach will answer · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 32:55